is expected to know basic theories and foundational concepts. But every field of knowledge is vast and complex, and one cannot know everything; nor is someone at the entry level expected to. So while facing an interview, it is important to be aware of what you can speak of with confidence, and what you are not too comfortable talking about. When faced with questions from this second area, you should be able to **graciously** admit that you don't know, or are not too sure.

4. Fudging as an answer in an interview can be disastrous. For one, interviewers are usually experienced enough to be able to tell when a candidate is just shooting the breeze. For another, if you really don't know the answer, you may get so involved in **faking** knowledge that you end up spinning a complicated web that you can't **extricate** yourself from. This may lead to follow-up questions that only make it worse. Instead, a simple "I'm afraid I don't know" could save you and your interviewers considerable misery and embarrassment.

5. Being able to say that you don't know requires confidence and **humility**. It is important to prepare well for any test, and to try to cover as much ground as possible, but it is equally important to **acknowledge** that it is impossible to know everything, particularly when there may be questions that combine theory, application and **strategy**. A sincere response that acknowledges the current limits of one's knowledge yet indicates a willingness and interest to learn would go a long way in making a good impression.

Glossary

panic (n)	-	sudden fear or anxiety
inadequate (adj.)	-	insufficient
fudge (n)	-	cover up
discerning (adj.)	-	judicious, enlightened
graciously (adv.)	-	pleasantly and kindly
faking (v)	-	pretending, falsify
extricate (v)	-	withdraw, free
humility (n)	-	humbleness
acknowledge (v)	-	accept, confess
strategy (n)	-	plan of action

b. On the basis of your understanding of the above passage, answer each of the questions given below by choosing the most appropriate option.

1. What happens when we do not know the answer to a question?

   a. lethargy sets in
   b. panic sets in
   c. expectation rises

2. Fudging in a written examination

   a. impresses people.
   b. persuades the examiner that you know something.
   c. improves your communication.

3. What are you expected to know in terms of subject knowledge in an interview?

   a. the complexities of a subject
   b. the basic theories and foundational concepts
   c. to assess yourself

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